Brice Fernandes

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Summary A versatile senior engineering leader who builds capability: in systems, in teams, and in the people who lead them. Experienced across the full software life cycle in complex and demanding environments, from embedded engineering to cloud-native architecture to running an engineering function, with unusual depth in governance, security and data protection. Key Achievements include being a founding coach on the University of Cambridge Judge Business School Startup Accelerator programmes and foundational contributions to the GitOps methodology.

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Experience

Director of Engineering at Raspberry Pi Foundation September 2024 - Present

Engineering leader for the Foundation's Digital Products division, accountable for engineering across multiple product teams building the learning platforms used by young people and educators worldwide. Line manager to the Engineering Manager cohort, reporting to the Chief Technology and Product Officer. Owned engineering vision and strategy, org design and resourcing, the engineering budget, and the security, compliance and data-protection posture of the digital estate. Member of the foundation's leadership team, representing engineering to the executive and management board.

- Designed and landed a technology-agnostic engineering career framework (Apprentice to Principal, plus a distinct management track), now in active use across 1:1s, reviews and progression decisions
- Established a working-group operating model with charters, tiers and explicit decision rights: eight autonomous groups covering security, architecture, AI, accessibility and people development with delegated authority and budget
- Owned the US and global data residency strategy for a public-sector opportunity of ∼1M students, authoring the costed brief that framed the executive decision
- Built the Foundation-wide data map (∼90 systems, 20 data categories, 25 data flows) as the evidence base for ROPA and ongoing privacy compliance
- Led the compliance and security programme for Digital Products: Cyber Essentials+, vendor security assessments, cloud access audits, software approval, business continuity and incident response
- Directed engineering AI adoption through an adoption plan, a dedicated working group, and an adoption-maturity reporting tool built with external partners
- Grew and stabilised the team through recruitment at every level, contractor procurement, and structured investment in people development, with measurable gains in retention

KEYWORDS: *Engineering Leadership, Org Design, Career Frameworks, People Development, Recruitment, Engineering Strategy, Architecture, Data Protection, GDPR, ROPA, Compliance, Cyber Essentials+, Security, Budget Ownership, Delivery Management, AI Adoption, Education, Nonprofit*

DevOps Practice Leader at Capgemini January 2022 - June 2024

Senior Leader of the DevOps practice for Capgemini UK Digital Customer Experience (DCX). Worked on commercial proposition development, aligning product, service and capability with both clients, market units, and other delivery areas in DCX and beyond. Owned the technology radar and external thought leadership for DevOps practice within the DCX delivery unit. Delivered client engagements for some of the UK's largest organisations.

- Worked on all aspects of capability management: products and offers, culture, training, recruitment and the career framework

- Senior technical leader on client engagements, owning technical architecture and ways of working
- Managed and mentored other senior leaders
- UK point of contact for Capgemini's Global DevOps Community
- Security cleared to work on National Critical Infrastructure

KEYWORDS: *Senior Leadership, DevOps, Capability Management, Architecture, Delivery Management, Digital Transformation, Career Frameworks, Training, Recruitment, Product Management, National Critical Infrastructure*

Senior Solution Architect at Weaveworks September 2018 - September 2021
Architected, developed and delivered hybrid cloud application platforms for some of the company's most high-profile clients, including in multiple regulated industries. Responsible for technical leadership and client relationships across commercial engagements, from pre-sales to delivery management, and for the design and delivery of GitOps and Cloud Native training for clients and partners.

- Helped define the principles of GitOps, since adopted as an open standard under the Cloud Native Computing Foundation, and taught them to clients, partners and the wider community
- Provided architecture consultancy for internal application platforms to global banks
- Led the design and architecture of the internal application platform to support the autonomous vehicle project of one of the world's largest companies
- Led the initial design and architecture workshop for the re-platforming effort of a large European telecommunication provider
- Trusted key-holder for critical internal systems
- Designed and implemented customer experience playbook

KEYWORDS: *GitOps, Customer Experience, Delivery management, Kubernetes, Cloud Native, Pre-sales engineering, Monitoring, Observability, Digital transformation, SRE, Training, Recruitment*

Senior Development Engineer at Weaveworks September 2017 - September 2018
Developed Go tools for managing Kubernetes at an open source company whose products (Flux, Weave Net, Weave Scope) were built in the open with their user communities. Helped define the GitOps methodology and communicate it to the developer community. Presented GitOps to conferences in the UK and internationally and delivered training on Kubernetes and GitOps. Member of the on-call engineering team directly responsible for the uptime and maintenance of the company's online SaaS platform.
KEYWORDS: *Kubernetes, GitOps, Cloud Native, Prometheus, Terraform, Go, On-Call, Incident response, DevOps, SRE, Developer Experience, Training, Recruitment*

Founder at Decacoder October 2015 - January 2017
Founded an online education company teaching developers through a custom-built platform. Led development of the media delivery platform and its continuous deployment pipeline on AWS, and was responsible for the educational design and student experience alongside every other area of the business. Served as the company's registered Data Protection Officer.
KEYWORDS: *Education, Founder, Product development, Leadership, Educational design, UX, Data protection, JavaScript, React, AWS, Continuous integration, Continuous deployment*

Software Engineer, Cambridge Broadband March 2011 - October 2013
Developed software for a microwave backhaul product: cross-platform graphical applications, embedded C network management over SNMP, and internal tools. Member of the process improvement team that redesigned the company's software and product development process. Took responsibility for recruiting C developers and for selecting and managing contractors.
KEYWORDS: *Embedded, C, Python, Linux, SNMP, Agile, Process improvement, Recruitment, Contractor management*

Teaching & Mentoring

Instructor, Unity3D Development Course August 2014 - August 2015

Designed and delivered an online course teaching programming and the fundamentals of computer science to novices through game development in C# and Unity3D. Funded through Kickstarter and delivered on Udemy, the course reached over 100,000 students and was accredited for 10 European Credit Transfer System credits (∼10% of an undergraduate degree).

KEYWORDS: *Education, Curriculum design, Computer science, Online learning, Game Development, C#, Unity3D, Kickstarter*

Startup Mentor & Founding Coach, Accelerate Cambridge 2013 - 2016

Selected as a founding coach and mentor for the University of Cambridge Judge Business School startup accelerator Accelerate Cambridge. Delivered a startup founder education curriculum and coached teams on product design, technology strategy, development process, team management, pitching for investment and clear communication. Several of the startups mentored received prestigious awards, including winning the Pitch@Palace competition.

KEYWORDS: *Startups, Coaching, Business modelling, Pitching, Leadership, Investment, Technology Strategy*

Instructor & Coach, Ignite Programme July 2015, July 2017

Instructor and coach on the University of Cambridge Judge Business School's Ignite programme, a one-week intensive course for early-stage enterprises. Led workshops that helped attendees apply the teaching to their own businesses.

KEYWORDS: *Startups, Education, Coaching, Leadership, Event facilitation, Business Modelling*

Founder, Cambridge Programmer Study Group July 2014 - December 2016

Founded the most active programming meetup in Cambridge, meeting twice a week to study computer science topics. Over two years the group studied Machine Learning, Cryptography, Concurrency and Functional programming, amongst other topics.

KEYWORDS: *Community building, Computer science education, Machine Learning, Neural Networks, Cryptography, Concurrency, Functional Programming, Compilers*

Skills

LEADERSHIP: Engineering strategy and vision, Org design and resourcing, Budget ownership, Technical recruitment, Career frameworks and progression, People development and coaching, Delivery and operations, Incident response and business continuity, Curriculum design and technical training.

GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE: Data protection (GDPR, ROPA, former Data Protection Officer), Online safety, Security programme ownership, Cyber Essentials Plus, Vendor security assessment, Data residency, Risk management, Policy and audit.

AI & DATA: AI adoption, LLM-assisted development workflows, Machine learning, Natural language processing, Agent-based modelling, Data mapping and governance.

TECHNOLOGY: Cloud native architecture, GitOps, Kubernetes, AWS, GCP, Terraform, Site Reliability Engineering, Observability, Python, Go, Rust, JavaScript, C, Functional programming, Test Driven Development.

Certification & Training

Santa Fe Institute Introduction to Agent Based Modelling	Achieved 2024
Scrum Alliance Certified Agile Leadership 2	Achieved 2024
Scrum Alliance Certified Agile Leadership 1	Achieved 2023
AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty	Achieved 2022
AWS Certified Security - Specialty	Achieved 2022
MIT Media Lab: AI-Generated Media Course	Achieved 2021
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional	Achieved 2020
AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional	Achieved 2020

Selected Talks

Embedded Test Driven Development March 2024
Slides and code available

SRE Best Practices October 2020
Video available

Bret Fisher's Docker and DevOps Podcast November 2019
Video available

Delivering Quality at Speed with GitOps August 2019
Video available

Building Objects With Functions June 2015
An interactive version as well as a recording are available.

Publications

The Evolution of Complementary Cognition: Humans Cooperatively Adapt and Evolve through a System of Collective Cognitive Search.
Taylor, H., Fernandes, B., & Wraight, S. (2021). Cambridge Archaeological Journal, 1-17.
doi: 10.1017/S0959774321000329

Education

BSc Physics with Computer Science, The University of Sheffield 2006 - 2010